
General SA’s

Curiosity, not wealth, drives my ambitions. Ever since I was little, when my dad first played the Cosmos television program, my interest in the world and aspects of space grew. My junior year was the first year I have taken physics and it proved to be one of my favorite classes. I haven't found a part of physics I dislike yet. But at the same time, my dad pushes me to make smart financial decisions (How to avoid debt, invest, and prepare for the future). Thus, I have researched jobs and hope to work as an astrophysicist to continue the stream of curiosity. For this dream to thrive, I need any help I can get to pay for college. That is why I need your help.

The universe is massive. The cosmos is essentially one giant place to explore. Since watching the show: "Cosmos" at a young age, I have gained an interest in the universe and its answers. Is there life on other faraway planets? Is a black hole really connected to a white hole by a wormhole? Will future power sources for humans really come from outer space and if so, what? So many questions and not enough answers. I want to know for myself. I want to research, clawing and scratching my way to answers of the universe. I want to continue my curiosity. And the next step to continue learning is by going to college.

I also love track and field. Going fast has been my number one rule since I could crawl. Getting back into track in Freshman year really revived this love for speed that I had since early childhood. In Junior year, my discovery of physics through a great physics teacher coincided with track further strengthening that love for running. I have had good coaches, great coaches, and bad ones too. After these experiences with coaches and teachers who have opened my world, in the future, I want to return to help others. After exploring new boundaries of science through a job I can hopefully get through a masters in physics and astronomy, I want to come back to school where it all started. I want to teach physics and coach track. I want to set so many people on the path to success, and if they want, greatness.

UT

Leadership stuff about track.

For the 2023 summer AAU track and field season, I joined a new track and field club. This one was called the Randolph Road Runners and compared to my old team of 5 runners, it was huge. But, I noticed one even bigger difference between the two. At the start of the season, there was no talking. Almost no one was communicating with one another outside of a few exceptions and the coaches. So, I tried to break some ice, especially with the little kids (age groups 4-12) because they need to be social to have fun. When we were warming up one day on the football field, I stuck out my hand to high-five the kids in my warm-up line. Some high-fived me back, some ignored my hand, and some completely ran in the opposite direction trying to dodge me. I repeated this for about five days, and by the fifth day, I had almost every little kid high-fiving and socializing. Later in the season, I noticed some little ones were having trouble with their start. I tried to help them and told them where to put their feet and what to do to gain the most speed. After a while, it seemed like everyone was helping everyone and the ice from the beginning of the season was gone. For UT, I hope to do the same exact thing. Maybe not with high-fives on a football field, but in the classroom, I want people to feel connected and have fun learning. I want people to live their best life.

Only first choice major

I love to share, help, and improve others. This stemmed not only from my childhood Mormonism, but also my (maybe hereditary) competitive nature. I also love researching and optimizing the things I love which probably also came from that competitive nature I seem to have had since birth. Finally, I love to go fast, which is probably an accumulation of both my helping trait and my competitive trait. Recently though, all of these main “traits” have blossomed my love for track because of its helping others aspect, and its extremely competitive side.

All of my life I have looked at how variables can be optimized and how they already have been. Last year though, when I tried physics, a whole new world of optimization opened up to me. Now, physics is the most appealing major to me because of its setting. Now I can optimize and improve everything, from the quality of life to the power of a physics instrument, to get better results in fields of research. Physics is just a playground for me and my exploration/optimization qualities. However, of course, I would still be happy to bring my qualities to economics and optimize there in research (I took OnRamps Economics). For my math choices, I chose them because I have always liked numbers and math. Exploring basic mathematic principles was fun in elementary as it is now.

Through first hand experiences, I know how valuable helping others can be to both the helped and the helper. All of the major factors of my life have shown me why. In track, the reward from helping others became more apparent. In the Mormon Church, I started my habit of looking out for other people. And through my parents, they taught me what it means to help another person. In UTSA, I don’t plan to stop. I want to jump into scholar communities to be the linking piece. I want to bring the people around me up. I want to help them. With both me and the people around me combined, there will be nothing that can stop us. If I can help accomplish this, then everyone will walk out of the communities a little stronger.

The scholar program is almost entirely lined up with the fields of research I want to conduct during my jobs. If I get in to the scholar program, cooperation, support, and communication should all take place in the scholar communities. My line of Physics research that I want to do also has heavy emphasis on those qualities. Therefore, if I strengthen those same qualities at the scholar community, then I should be prepared pretty nicely for that job later in life. It also lies in the same line as being a track & field coach much later down the line, as communicating, supporting, and cooperating with the kids will be very important. If I do get into the scholars program, then all of my long term goals will get a little closer.

Describe how your experiences, perspectives, talents, and/or your involvement in leadership activities (at your school, job, community, or within your family) will help you to make an impact both in and out of the classroom while enrolled at UT.

Spaghettification is a scientific term used when an object or organism becomes stretched to an almost infinite length because of gravity acting upon it. I have always loved spaghetti. The way my Mom made it, the taste would unravel on the tongue and give off a medley of love. The saliva used to dissolve food is made of the same primary atoms as the big, blazing stars that later collapse into frigid, foreboding black holes. I learned that on Cosmos, a scientific television show that explores the sizzling stars nearby to the far corners of the cold universe. The Cosmos host, Neil deGrasse Tyson, was the person who opened up my world to science. The way this man explained the rules of science on our old plasma TV was almost poetic. He spoke with a certain rhythm that I would hold close when I was too sick to go to school. I've read the huge black hole in the middle of our galaxy can hold around 3 million Earths in it. Some people think that black holes could be portals, tunnels to "white holes," or to other places entirely. My mind also has been in other places, past the clouds, and in the stars. Recently though, my head was pulled from the Milky Way when I started taking OnRamps Physics I. The world seemed to illuminate more clearly and realistically to me than ever before. The cosmos is massive and all of it can be explored by humans. Us. We can explore it. I want to join these pioneers. The astrophysicists. Behind corners of glittering stardust, what could be there? Are there other forms of life? Different plants, animals, or …humans? Let's test our beliefs. Let's test our courage, determination, and curiosity. Let's see the cosmos.

My work in Track and Field is most dear to me. When I can give advice to a kid, he/she runs faster, and comes to thank me with a bright smile, it gives me the best feeling in the world. No matter how small the notion is, I love helping people in track field so they grow their confidence, life skills, and/or passion for the sport. I don't care if I am remembered, I just want these people to look back and feel like they had a great time.

The core purpose of The University of Texas at Austin is, *To Transform Lives for the Benefit of Society.* Please share how you believe your experience at UT-Austin will prepare you to *Change the World* after you graduate.

+55 words

I want to revolutionize something. My ambition has always been great, but what I have done so far

isn’t going to cut it. I want to flip the world. I want to discover something absolutely outrageous on the scientific horizon. I want to be the person that kids look up to when they think of a scientist. The one who sparked my love for science was the Cosmos host, Neil deGrasse Tyson. The way this man explained the rules of science on our old plasma TV was almost poetic. He spoke with a certain rhythm that I would clutch close and rely on when I was too sick to go to school. I brought that information back to the classroom and shared all I had learned with my classmates. I wanted to learn then, and, if anything, I want to learn even more now. Back then I shared the food I had gathered with my class. Now, I want to gather food for everyone. The whole world. I want to feast on the laws of science, as well as new areas of our universe. I want to inspire people just like he did to me.
T w

I expect to have the most trouble with english. Ever since I was little, my grammar and idea explanation has been a little questionable. Some of my bad habits have continued, and sometimes I tend to over complicate my ideas, leading to misunderstandings. Both my grammar sections on the ACT and SAT are lower than where I want them. But, I expect that when I am struggling, I will go to the writing center, study groups, or communicate with the professor. I do expect to struggle, but I also expect to grow.

Vanderbilt

Track meets are terrifying. This past summer, I participated in the biggest track meet I have gone to yet. Long and triple jump at South Texas Regionals. Extremely tough competitors were there and jumping against me. A top-in-the-nation jumper who placed in Nike nationals, the second placer at AAU nationals last year, and other upcoming great D1 athletes. Just thinking about this track meet is making my hands sweaty typing about this meet. It wasn’t my best performance at all, but while I was there I realized that I could compete with the top. I can hold my own with these people who have the most grit I have ever seen in my life. I can see how they achieved their goals and what I need to do in order to achieve mine. I, someone who was shoved to the side in Middle School to run the mile for points, was now competing in the most explosive, demanding, and nerve-racking event in track and field at the South Texas Regional. This very track meet has shown me how to bring my best and how strong I currently am both physically and mentally. With this track meet in mind I hope to only move forward to even more terrifying track meets.

Texas A&M

The person who has impacted my life the most is my Dad. He isn't always here to help at the house because he is usually at work, but his messages always hit the hardest. He has taught me how to utilize money, how to think for yourself, and how to question the absolute. Lately, my Dad wanted me to read "The Millionaire Next Door" a book that teaches you how to become wealthy and how most millionaires have become so. He wanted me to learn so I could be comfortable later in my life. My Dad is my leading role model because of how he thinks about the world, its people, and its societies. I hope that sometime in the future, he will look at me and be proud.

My Dad has given me the most valuable lesson I have received. He isn't always here to help at the house because he is usually at work, but his messages always hit the hardest. He has taught me how to utilize money, how to think for yourself, and how to question the absolute. Lately, my Dad wanted me to read "The Millionaire Next Door" a book that teaches you how to become wealthy and how most millionaires have become so I could be comfortable later in my life. But these teachings are not the most valuable to me. What is most valuable is how he has taught me so much. My dad has shown me how the greatest act is, the act of teaching.

Using an AI/LLM platform of your choice (e.g ChatGPT, Bard, Sudowrite), provide any important details describing who you are and what your aspirations are, and then prompt the platform to write a college application essay explaining why you want to pursue your chosen field (or how you should figure out what to pursue if you're not sure yet) and how the University Honors Program will help you pursue that. Keeping in mind your own unique voice and distinct vision, and that we will be looking for evidence of your vision, self-awareness, and willingness to take an intellectual risk, evaluate how well the platform does at presenting its argument. What assumptions does it get right or wrong? What important details does it leave out? Creative responses are appreciated!
We recommend that you give yourself plenty of time for reflection & multiple drafts. Please submit only your evaluation of the platform's argument, not the generated text itself (max. 250 words). Please paste your completed response in the box below.

Hello! I am a very diligent worker with love

RICE

Please explain why you wish to study in the academic areas you selected above.*

In my mind, I am a picture-perfect, Amazon explorer, cutting through the jungle leaves with my machete while wearing my Pith helmet. Through perilous treks, I am constantly discovering new and exciting possibilities in the Amazon Rainforest. But in reality, a Rainforest does not lie quite within my realm of exploration. Instead, I have always loved exploring new ways to harness numbers to my advantage. Whether through video games, school, or club track and field, I am always looking for numerical values that will give me the edge. But most recently, physics has been my focus of exploration. The formulas in physics have increased my knowledge of the physical world around me, which lets me compare and analyze numbers of the physical world. I could explore the world while optimizing it at the same time. For example, I could take apart a circuit and tell you how efficient it is on a percentage from 1 to 100. I could determine the top speed of a car compared to its actual speed. Physics is the perfect jungle for me to explore. Hopefully, in the near future, I can further explore the physics I love right now. After a decade of constant comparing, I still am not satisfied. In UT I want to study physics to continue this numerical crusade about the world around me. I want a new discovery of my own in the jungle of physics and help the current physics jungle. I want to explore numbers and their possibilities by going to UT.

Rice is a very appealing college for three major reasons to me. First, I love the professor's enthusiasm for their jobs. In every single Zoom information session I have attended, the professors have been extremely happy and willing to talk about their time at the university. Specifically, Professor Helb’s enthusiasm for the business program took me back and I was kind of wowed by how much she loved her job. Second, the majors I want to pursue are very strong options at Rice. After attending the information sessions on all possible areas of interest, I love how great the people who share a major with me are. Finally, the location is perfect. Not only do I have cousins in Houston but the NASA center is right next to campus, as well as the organization is a popular employer, so my dream job is closer than ever.

The questions on this page are being asked by Rice University

The Admission Committee is interested in getting to know each student as well as possible through the application process. Please respond to each of the following prompts (150 words or less).

Please explain why you wish to study in the academic areas you selected above.

Based upon your exploration of Rice University, what elements of the Rice experience appeal to you?

The Rice Box: In keeping with Rice's long-standing tradition, please share an image of something that appeals to you.

If you would like to upload a resume, you may do so now or at a later time.

Describe a topic, idea, or concept you find so engaging that it makes you lose all track of time. Why does it captivate you? What or who do you turn to when you want to learn more?

Why u?

ESSAYS

Relate to highschool now.

To me, optimization is a symbol of strength and creativity. Numbers are the tallies of that strength and can be infinitely compared to continually fine-tune and improve the quality of life for everyone. I love helping people with my numbers and observations. Recently in track, my talent for Contrary to the belief of "cold numbers", I believe all numbers are warm, friendly, and advantageous if utilized correctly. First, my school peers in the track class (almost) always appreciate my help. I can rework forms based on times, or jump distances. And in a more casual scene, I use numbers to help myself and others in video games for fun. I have many passions that I love, and throughout my life and my learning, I have come to utilize numbers more and more to help me through what I like.

Track is about speed no matter the event so optimization of speed is essential. My events are the long jump, triple jump, the 100-meter race, and the 200-meter race. Every single one of those events requires a huge amount of speed. To gain this speed I have two things, a mind ready to learn speed and a mentality ready to put the work into practice. Optimization in Track is the marrying of those two ideas. After freshman year, I kind of had an epiphany when I looked at my past and realized I have loved going fast my entire life. Summer of freshman year I joined an AAU team called 3D's AAU Club. The coach was great and he introduced me to many track terms which I tried my best to implement into my running. Dorsalflexion, "slicing the ground", "eye socket to hip pocket", a-skip, b-skip, c-skip, z-skip, the penultimate step, and more. I learned all of these terms from my coach (now a head track coach of a San Antonio university, and soon to be head coach of North Point Military College).

I have always loved going fast. My younger days contained me racing against imaginary opponents and constantly asking my dad if he liked my speed to which he responded "You're pretty fast." I wanted to know my times. I liked to race at recess. I liked knowing the number of laps I completed at the school run. I always liked to know my school-wide ranking of speed across the classes and would constantly compete against others. But this competitiveness looks puny to how competitive I am now, in Highschool. Learning 2D motion, forces, centripetal motion, and how the body works from both biology and physics has shown me just how to get faster. Using my learned knowledge I would "plug and chug" trying to help other people based on their times for specific races.

My love for collating numbers has not yet been satisfied. Everywhere I look, I see new things that need optimization. I want to continue to help people through numbers. Whether through economics, astrophysics, or even as an actuary. There are many options for me to follow, but most of all I want to be able to analyze and compare.

If you want to change it to rice, just show how it relates to rice and add more passion.

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The person who has impacted my life the most is my dad. He is not always here to help at the house because he is usually at work, but his messages always hit the hardest. He has taught me how to utilize money, how to think for yourself, and how to question the absolute. Lately, my dad wanted me to read "The Millionaire Next Door," a book that teaches you how to become wealthy and how most millionaires have become so. He wanted me to learn so I could be comfortable later in my life. My dad is my leading role model because of how he thinks about the world, its people, and its societies. I hope that in the future, I will continue to make my dad proud.

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I love velocity. Going fast gives a fleeting high feeling that comes in rushes from the increasing "G's" on my body. Seeing my surroundings speed and blur past me makes everything surreal. Rushing down the hill, through the neighborhoods, and around the school track wasn't enough. I wanted to learn more. From elementary to the present I raced everyone asking, "Who's the fastest?". My need for speed bled into the classroom. I favored numbers because of how fast you could go with them. No slowing down like reading. A blend of school and speed began to mix and create something entirely new, but for now, it was only a tiny seed. In high school, it has bloomed.

At the end of my freshman year, I discovered club track and field, and my love for speed grew by the day. I learned correct arm movements, leg movements, and head positions. We sprinted hard at practice and sprinted fast at the track meets. At the end of the club season, I had beaten my personal record in almost every single track meet. In my sophomore year, along with club track and field, my schedule had Pre-Calculus, the most challenging math class I have ever had up to that point. I still loved math and numbers at this time, so seeing my times drop in races and my grades rise in classes was extremely satisfying. There was only one problem with my schedule. Chemistry stood out like a sore thumb. It had math, but chemistry did not have enough math for me to consider it a "math" class. It had English and long reading with tedious memorization, but it wasn't so bad that I had to choke it down like the other English classes. It was obvious: chemistry was just not the exact match that I was looking for. Exploring the properties of the universal units of atoms and molecules in chemistry was

fine, a step up from biology for me, but it wasn't those numbers I was craving along with track and field. This same year, I got new personal records in all of my school track and field events and my knowledge of speed was growing by the day. I just needed something to balance it out and to replace chemistry.

In junior year, I tried Physics OnRamps. My thought process was that physics would be a more math-involved science so I would like it better than something like AP Chemistry. Up through my junior year, physics was the best class I had ever taken in my life (beaten only by Physics OnRamps II). The very first unit was about speed and 2D motion. The same speed that I had chased after all of my life! Through numbers, I found velocity in various situations. By solving physics problems I developed a better idea of what velocity was. With both physics and track, I began to learn how to get faster at a rate uncontested by my past.

Now, as a senior, I have the lucky opportunity to do what I love twice a day at track practice and in physics class. I am grateful to do what I love, but I don't intend to stop. I will use high school and this combination of physics and track and field to spring into college, learning all the way.

Intro:

Why I like optimization and how i have helped people with it through my life

(need: better hook, the universe in about __ years will have no humans.

Body 1:

Track's importance to me and the constant optimization of it.

Body 2:

Ehhh

Body 3:

Good, but I have to make it seem extremely sweaty and that when I find something i like I REALLY go at it. (frame data, yugioh, splatoon)

Body1: They are probably not mormon so explain stuff to them

Body2: Explain why I began to go away from being mormon.

Body 3: How it has changed me, (the going away) opened my ideas to critical thinking and seeing other people differently (BE RESPECTFUL the person reading could be religious) and opening my mind to other people by closing one of my worlds.

Body3: Explain life after mormon +how mormon still influences and how it is still in my life

Body4: conclusion

Dang it was a bad word phrase in my household only 10 years ago. Kind of ridiculous right? With the circumstances though, it might not have been all that surprising. We were Mormon at this time and extremely devoted. Strict rules enforced by my parents made us live life in a specific way where we followed what we thought was “the one true church of Jesus Christ” so that my parents could raise us kids the “right way”. As a Mormon, there are things of worship that are always reminded of add daily stuff. This is the story of how my life changed and why I am not applying to BYU like almost every other Mormon.

Our eventual split away from Mormonism began once we moved to Texas. The intensity of worship and claims about them being “the true church” were a lot more fierce and so, my Dad began to research the church’s past to find what caused these differences in behaviors. Researching the church’s past led to finding recorded events outside of the church’s history that were pretty terrible. It turns out that Joseph Smith (the founder of Latter-Day Saints) had multiple wives, one of which he stole from his friend. This definitely agitated my dad, so he continued looking into the church’s past for redeeming factors. He found even worse wrongdoings (some worse than stealing your best friend's wife) and began questioning the church. I see where he was coming from very clearly. In my classes, people were much different than my peers back in Boise, Idaho. When my dad finally turned his questions to the church and the people in charge of it he got the answer “They are lies do not stray from the path of God”. But mountains of evidence pointing the other way that had been hypothesized, tested and proved. I understood why my dad was beginning to question the church, and came to terms with the idea of us not going to the church any longer. After our split, the most immediate response was our family. For a long time, our family was so confused and frightened about us leaving the church. They scorned my parents and demanded how they would raise us without the example of the bible. They could not see how to live without the church, and we were forced to learn just that.

A new door had seemed to open. “Now, my Sundays could be utilized for work or play!” Those were the ideas I first thought of. Only weeks later, however, I realized that it was not my Sunday that opened up, instead it was my mind. Now that the Mormon's judging and aloofness (of course not all Mormons have this but some did have that “we are of the true church and we are better” vibe) was gone from our family, I could see my peers a lot more clearly. My friends who had seemed bullies now just looked like sad kids who were kind of neglected. My grades in class improved (I’m not joking) because I would not relate church to everything I did, which led to me being less distracted. My critical thinking of others, and of theories also improved so I feel like I became kinder and more social.

Despite our disagreements and everything I say, the church still helped me to grow into who I am now. The Mormon church helped teach me the basics of how to act and gave me great early childhood friends. Mormonism along with my parents and their beliefs has taught me to strive to be a great person allowing my positive outlook on life, and my perseverance. It is this church and the people around me who have forged me into the way I am today. For that, I am grateful to them all.

QuestBridge

Tell us about one of your proudest achievements or moments and what it says about you.

A mindset. A boring mindset sets my mind apart from others. I have been put through a lot and worked hard to get this mindset.

Regionals

Helping People and seeing them successful

Having the mindset to keep improving at track

If you could meet a character from a book or a historical figure, who would it be and what would you ask them?

I have always been an Egyptian nerd. My love for Yu-Gi-Oh and Egyptian studies in elementary school have always left me extremely curious about one big thing. The Pyramids. Imhotep was an architectural genius, and my recent classes in physics just make me question how Imhotep even accomplished such a feat. Without the use of heavy machinery, advanced mathematics, or even a natural landscape which made it easier to stack the pyramid's blocks, Imhotep's genius accomplished making the Pyramids of Giza by somehow stacking the blocks 450 feet tall while making passageways and traps inside the pyramids. If I could go back in time, speak in his language, and appear welcoming, then I would ask how he figured out how to make the pyramids. What drove him to find the solution to make them? Did he use calculations or just reasoning? Imhotep could actually be a super "genius" To me, there are too many mysteries and not enough answers. Hopefully, Imhotep can solve them.

Answer the following questions in no more than 35 words, which is about 3 sentences. You may use comma-separated lists instead of sentences when appropriate.

What is your favorite subject to study, and why?

Physics is my favorite subject because it is math and problem-solving in a variety of different fields. I do of course prefer some fields of study over others, but overall it is very fun.

What are your favorite books and/or movies?

What is your favorite source of inspiration?

How do you spend a typical weekend?

TRACK! When club track is in season, we do a track meet every single weekend. On other weekend days, I either work or try to relax during the day (homework is relaxing for me).

What compliment are you most proud of receiving and who gave it to you?

I love when people say “You’re so funny, Will.” I try to cheer people up by being funny by finding what my peers think is funny. That way I can hit their sweet spots.

After a challenging experience, how do you rejuvenate?

I rejuvenate with alone time. My mindset is very competitive and optimistic (not always the best mix) so if you just leave me alone for a while, I kind of get riled up and start working again.

What would you contribute to your future college campus community?

I would be a teacher. I would guide others and be a reliable person to ask for help. Hard classes would become easier for classmates with me as their peer.

The nature of people isn’t good or bad. No, people who agree with the concepts of “good” or “evil” think too simply. Personally, I think something else entirely. Man’s nature is fire. Fire that grows hot through fuel of compatible ambitions. Fire that merge together with other fires to make more powerful forms of influence in this society. Fires that split off making different forms of thinking. Half haphazardly trying other ambitions and randomly flickering around. Fire that grows hot in conflicts over fuel,

Top Scholar UTSA

Five sentences

I love to share, help, and improve and others. This stemmed not only through practicing Mormonism as a kid, but also my competitive nature. I also enjoy researching and optimizing the things I love like track, Hearthstone (a video game), . Finally, I love to go fast, which is probably an accumulation of both my helping trait and my competitive trait. Recently though, all of these main “traits” have blossomed my love for track and field because of its helping others aspect, and its extremely competitive side.

Suggestion:

I love to share and help like when (give an example of sharing or helping others). I like to improve myself (let's focus back on you here instead of others, give an example -- how to you improve yourself?). I also enjoy researching and optimizing the things I love like track, Hearthstone (a video game), school efficiency. (Give an example: What does that look like?) Finally, I love to go fast, which is probably an accumulation of both my helping trait (how does helping relate to going fast??) and my competitive nature.

Learning Experiences Beyond the Classroom

My dad has given me the most valuable lessons. He is not always around to help at the house because he is usually at work, but his messages always hit the hardest. My dad has given me three big lessons in life that I follow every single day. The first one is thoughtfulness. My dad always talks to me about being thoughtful in making the best possible decisions. He encourages me to question everything right, wrong, or in-between. Currently, I am using this lesson to determine what college to attend by being thoughtful about each university's cost, opportunities, and communities. The next lesson is self-care. One of my dad's favorite quotes is from Deion Sanders, "If you look good, you feel good. If you feel good, you play good. If you play good, they pay good." To help me learn this principle my dad gives me self-care chores which I have had as long as I can remember. Exercising regularly, always brushing my hair and teeth, and getting plenty of sleep are some of the required chores. Consistently practicing these self-care chores helps me to stay happy and healthy. Last but not least, my dad has helped me learn adaptability. Inevitably, unfavorable scenarios come up and my dad wants me to be adaptable to all situations. For example, recently my AAU track coach moved his practices 45 minutes away. With the new practices being too far away and costly, I had to adapt and switch teams. Adapting can be tricky, but it is necessary to learn since life is unexpected and constantly changing. My dad has helped shape my life by teaching me these three principles over and over again. I am grateful my dad has taught me these powerful lessons.

The Way You See the World

Our split from Mormonism began in Idaho and with my dad. To show you why we split from Mormonism and how it affected me, you have to know one thing: my dad questions everything. My dad loves epistemology for everything, whether it is the stock market (he is a blue chip investor), science, words to use, or the psychology of people around him. My dad wants to know why. It was the same way with the Church which led to our eventual parting of ways. The Mormon church believed that their gospel was the absolute truth, but my dad simply asked why. My dad always talks to us about being cautious and making the best decisions. He encourages us to question everything right, wrong, or in-between. I also began to see things differently. I looked at the world instead with curiosity instead of certainty. In 3rd grade math class I went from wandering through meaningless tallies to wondering about the infinite possibilities they could be used in. When I looked at other people, instead of seeing them as either Mormon and non-Mormon, I saw them all as peers trying to also find their own way in the world with all different kinds of beliefs and values. Not anymore was it "good" and "evil," but instead me and Earth

Some of the Latter-Day Saint teachings did rub off on me though. Now (and back then), I try my best to be respectful and nice. For example, even though the rest of my extended family practices Mormonism, I can look past the differences and see them as both relatives and friends. Both my family and the church have built me into the person I am today.

Which course or subject will be most difficult?

I expect to have the most trouble with English. Ever since I was little, verbal and written communication have been tricky for me, especially grammar. I tend to over complicate my ideas, leading to misunderstandings. Both my grammar sections on the ACT and SAT were lower than where I would like them. But when I am struggling at UTSA, I plan to go to the writing center, ask for help in my study groups, and reach out to the professor. I do expect to struggle, but I also expect to grow. Because I believe with hard work, I can fortify this weakness and possibly turn it into a strength.

More than just good grades

Through first-hand experiences, I know how valuable helping others can be to both the helped and the helper. (how about talking about working at the Food Bank versus getting food from the Summer Food Service Program during the summer?) All of the major factors of my life have shown me why. (Give another example, like maybe something from National Honor Society--many ways to serve like working at the elementary's Fall Festival. Maybe talk about an experience serving in the community and how it makes you feel more connected to them. It could be our tradition of giving Christmas gifts to neighbors and how that strengthens our relationship with our neighbors where knowing them, smiling, and saying hi, helps everyone feel safer and have a better sense of belonging. As you interact with roommates by holding a door or saying hi or sitting by someone by themselves at dinner, you develop relationships and build a better community). In track, the reward from helping others became more apparent. In the Mormon Church, I started my habit of looking out for other people. And through my parents, they taught me what it means to help another person. In UTSA, I don’t plan to stop. I want to jump into scholar communities to be the linking piece. I want to bring the people around me up. I want to help them. With both me and the people around me combined, there will be nothing that can stop us. If I can help accomplish this, then everyone will walk out of the communities a little stronger.

Thousands of non-honors graduates of Texas A&M are well prepared for and obtain their first choice medical school, law school, graduate school, or employment after they graduate each year. If you were guaranteed the admission or job of your choice without being in the University Honors Program, why would the Honors Program be an essential experience for you? (250 Words Maximum)* Please paste your completed response in the box below.

The Honors Program gives experiences missed otherwise. A community of like-minded people, tighter-knit groups of peers, and expanded course options.

Please tell us about your future educational goals including:

- **What do you plan to study and why?**
- **What responsibilities have you learned in life that will help you to attain your goals? Please include a comment about your level of commitment to your plan.**

In college, I plan on studying Physics. Do you know the word, spaghettification? It is a scientific term used when an object or organism becomes stretched to an almost infinite length because of gravity acting upon it. The word reminds me of spaghetti which I have always loved spaghetti. The way my Mom made it, the taste would unravel on the (my?) tongue and give off a medley of flavor and love. The saliva used to dissolve food is made of the same primary atoms as the big, blazing stars that later collapse into frigid, foreboding black holes. I learned that on Cosmos, a scientific television show that explores the sizzling stars nearby to the far corners of the cold universe. The Cosmos host, Neil deGrasse Tyson, was the person who opened up my world to science. The way this man explained the rules of science on our old plasma TV was almost poetic. He spoke with a certain rhythm that I would hold close to when (Instead: found soothing when) I was too sick to go to school.

Maybe add a variation of the jungle exploration paragraph?
Since my discovery of Cosmos, I have been drawn to physics. In my mind, I am a picture-perfect, Amazon explorer, cutting through the jungle leaves with my machete while wearing my Pith helmet. Through perilous treks, I am constantly discovering exciting areas of physics and its possibilities. The formulas in physics have increased my knowledge of the physical world around me, which lets me compare and analyze numbers of the physical world. I like to explore the world while optimizing it at the same time. For example, I could take apart a circuit and tell you how efficient it is on a percentage from 1 to 100. I could determine the top speed of a car compared to its actual speed. Physics is the perfect jungle for me to explore. Hopefully, in the near future, I can further explore the physics I love right now. In college, I want to study physics to continue this numerical and scientific crusade in the world around me. I want a new discovery of my own in the jungle of physics and help the current physics jungle.

A possible transition to "**responsibilities have you learned in life that will help you to attain your goals'**
To explore and study physics as an undergraduate and a graduate student, requires discipline. I know being successful in my classes and balancing my social life and my everyday selfcare with my studies will not be easy. However, I feel like I am prepared for this challenge by two things: participating in track and field and internalizing lessons I learned at home. First, track and field takes dedication. Track and Field is the sport where you grow and "pr" (personal record) the slowest. The rate at which you improve can sometimes be discouraging. Constant dedication is the only remedy. I love practicing and having fun growing every day. No matter the weather, I always love to have fun at

track practice. Some days the practice is extremely rough (5, 350 meters at 85% top speed), and some days it is not so bad. But day in and day out, I love practicing every day. The other way I have practiced discipline throughout my life is from lessons taught by my parents. My parents are people who love knowledge and are curious about the world around them. So to help me in my own life, they have taught me the many lessons they have learned in all of their years. Then you could do a paragraph about your persistence and dedication in track and field (showing up for long practices with grit and doing the workout not matter what–give examples). You could also do a paragraph on lessons learned at home like doing your household responsibilities like clearing the table or dishes or cleaning a bathroom–a small thing, but if not done regularly it can backlog and feel overwhelming. You translated this to high school breaking up long assignments and projects.

And then conclude with restating what you want to study, how you are ready to take on the responsibility of college, and how you are committed to this pursuit.

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I also love track and field. Going fast has been my number one rule since I could crawl. Getting back into track in Freshman year really revived this love for speed that I had since early childhood. In Junior year, my discovery of physics through a great physics teacher coincided with track further strengthening that love for running. I have had good coaches, great coaches, and bad ones too. After these experiences with coaches and teachers who have opened my world, in the future, I want to return to help others. After exploring new boundaries of science through a job I can hopefully get through a masters in physics and astronomy, I want to come back to school where it all started. I want to teach physics and coach track. I want to set so many people on the path to success, and if they want, greatness.

At school, I loved to race and play tag. The “G’s” on my body would offer sets of thrill unachievable otherwise on the surface of this planet. In high school, I began to compete with my speed and had fun running and jumping. But every time I would think about jumping, I always look up and think about stars. **Maybe something right here?** I’ve read that the huge black hole in the middle of our galaxy can hold around 3 million Earths in it. Some people think that black holes could be portals, tunnels to “white holes,” or to other places entirely. My mind also has been in other places, past the clouds, and in the stars. But recently, I looked at reality. I can turn what I have dreamed about all my life, while doing the things I love. It just all comes down to planning.

Special Circumstances (finacial)

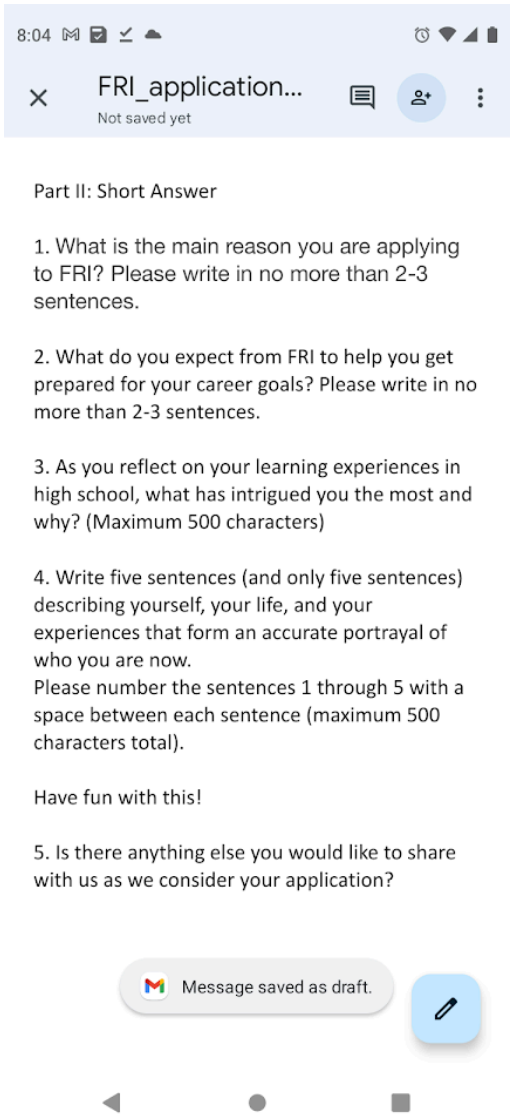
My dad owns and operates a pool service business. He is the only employee and services 57 pools per week every week. He works outside all year in all types of weather throughout all the seasons. This job is very physically demanding, so he is very careful to stay fit and healthy so our income will not drop. He is good at meeting the needs of his customers. Because he is self-employed, my dad has to set aside money for his retirement. This is one of the big reasons I have to pay for all of my college (the other being responsibility for my education). My mom chose to stop working when she

had me so she could be my and my siblings' caretaker. She runs the household: getting us where we need to go, rescuing my dad when his work truck breaks down, cooking a lot of healthy food for us, and teaching us life skills like cleaning bathrooms, scrubbing floors, washing and folding laundry, vacuuming, cooking, and supporting us in our classes. Eighteen months ago, my mom started substitute teaching once a week which has helped my family financially since our cost of living continues to rise (auto insurance for me, braces for my brother, the ever-rising price of health insurance, etc).

For San Antonio Area Foundation Scholarships due February 24

1. **Describe a life experience and how this experience influenced your decision to pursue higher education.(250 words)**

2. **What is your career goal for the future? How will your career goal help you to make a positive impact on your community? (250 words)**



For FRI Application

1. I would love to be in FRI because I love research. Research of any kind really. But recently, my favorite world of research has been physics. In FRI, I would try my best to help professors with the frontiers of physics!
2. I hope that FRI gets me connected with people currently in the world of research.
3. I love physics, so the main subject I was intrigued by was physics. In physics, I love studying space. I want to find out what dark matter is, explore properties of the universe, and look for new ways to use the universe! For me, everything in space just looks like one big field of exploration that we can always know more about.
4. 1 I love training for my hobbies: track and field and school work. 2 I know neither sounds that exciting, but I love improving myself and my ideas through the resources surrounding me. 3 I like researching through the internet or through other people to learn more about what I love. 4 I try my hardest to always improve and to help other people

around me. 5 Hopefully in the future, I can help more people and bring more people into track and field!

Briefly describe the type of research projects you are interested in. (*Please limit to 200 words*)

Describe previous research experience, if any. (*Please limit to 200 words*)

In my physics classes, I completed labs facilitated by UT OnRamps. My favorite lab subjects were about gravity and waves. The wave lab had a cool machine where it would hit a frequency and the frequency would produce a wave on the string. Through the lab we established some of the wave formulas such as the bulk modulus and the velocity equation.

On my own, I love optimizing everything I do. I like researching and knowing what is "the best" in all of my hobbies. In track and field, I am constantly looking at what professionals do and comparing my running form and jumping form to theirs. I observe the differences and then implement those techniques in my practices. In video games, I go to gaming forums to find the optimal strategies. I love finding the "best" in everything I do.